

Two Roads of Faith

Current company version · generated from the structured master script

CHOSEN: THE STORY BEFORE THE MANGER

SCENE 7 — TWO ROADS OF FAITH

Approximate Running Time: 7 minutes

Musical Material: Short “Chosen” reprise — 45–60 seconds

Characters: Mary, Elizabeth, Joseph, Levi, Malachi, Caleb, Ezra, Angel Voice / Messenger

TRANSITION FROM SCENE 6

No traditional blackout.

Mary remains beside the unfinished table for one final breath after Joseph exits. A fragile trace of “Chosen” may remain underneath.

The stage separates into two simultaneous worlds.

MARY’S ROAD: warm, domestic, safe. Simple elements suggest Elizabeth’s home.

JOSEPH’S ROAD: The workshop remains. The unfinished table, tools, and empty places where his friends stood are still visible.

Mary moves toward Elizabeth. Joseph moves back toward the men. They never see one another.

Two people leaving the same wound in opposite directions.

MARY’S ROAD — ELIZABETH

Elizabeth is occupied with an ordinary household task. Mary appears at the edge of the space.

Before entering, Mary wipes her face and tries to make herself presentable. She has been holding herself together since Joseph left.

ELIZABETH

Mary?

Mary stops.

Something changes in Elizabeth before Mary explains anything. Elizabeth’s hand moves instinctively toward her own stomach.

ELIZABETH

Oh...

MARY

What?

ELIZABETH

The moment I heard your voice...

Elizabeth feels the child move.

ELIZABETH

Mary.

She looks at her with wonder.

ELIZABETH

Blessed are you.

Mary stares at her.

MARY

What did you say?

ELIZABETH

The child within me moved when he heard you.

Mary's breath catches.

ELIZABETH

God has done something.

For the first time since Gabriel, Mary does not have to explain herself.

MARY

You know?

ELIZABETH

I know enough.

MARY

You believe me?

ELIZABETH

Yes.

That is what finally breaks through Mary's composure. Not collapse—release.

Elizabeth opens her arms. Mary goes to her.

JOSEPH'S ROAD — THE MEN

Mary remains with Elizabeth as Joseph's side comes forward.

Levi, Caleb, Ezra, and Malachi are with Joseph. The ease of Scene 5 is gone. Joseph has told them enough.

CALEB

Mary?

JOSEPH

Yes.

CALEB

Our Mary?

Joseph looks at him.

JOSEPH

Yes, Caleb.

CALEB

I just...

He cannot make the thought fit.

CALEB

Mary?

JOSEPH

That was my reaction.

A tiny breath of recognition, not a joke.

EZRA

She said an angel came to her.

JOSEPH

Yes.

EZRA

And the child comes from God.

JOSEPH

That's what she told me.

Ezra thinks. No conclusion comes.

LEVI

Then you know what to do.

JOSEPH

Do I?

LEVI

End it quietly.

Joseph looks at him.

LEVI

Don't shame her. Don't drag her through the village. But don't let this destroy you either.

JOSEPH

Levi—

LEVI

You love her. I know.

Beat.

LEVI

But protect yourself.

Malachi watches. Caleb looks miserable. Ezra is still thinking.

BACK TO MARY — THE QUESTION SHE DOESN'T WANT

MARY

Joseph doesn't believe me.

Elizabeth lets the sentence exist.

MARY

I thought if I told him the truth...

ELIZABETH

He would understand.

MARY

Yes.

Beat.

MARY

He looked at me like he didn't know what was true anymore.

ELIZABETH

Mary...

Elizabeth waits until Mary looks at her.

ELIZABETH

If Joseph had come to you yesterday and told you this story—

Mary already knows the question.

ELIZABETH

Would you have believed him?

Mary wants to answer quickly. She cannot.

MARY

I don't know.

ELIZABETH

Neither does he.

MARY

That doesn't make it hurt less.

ELIZABETH

No.

Beat.

ELIZABETH

It doesn't.

No easy spiritual answer.

MARY

I said yes.

ELIZABETH

I know.

MARY

I thought saying yes was the hard part.

Elizabeth understands.

ELIZABETH

Sometimes saying yes is only the beginning.

JOSEPH'S ROAD — WHAT DO WE ACTUALLY KNOW?

LEVI

Say you're done.

CALEB

Levi—

LEVI

What?

CALEB

I know Mary.

LEVI

So does Joseph.

CALEB

Exactly.

Joseph looks at Caleb.

CALEB

That's what makes this so...

JOSEPH

Impossible?

CALEB

Yeah.

Malachi finally speaks.

MALACHI

Did you pray?

JOSEPH

What?

MALACHI

Did you pray?

JOSEPH

Malachi, I know what happened.

MALACHI

No.

Beat.

MALACHI

You know what it looks like.

That lands.

JOSEPH

There is a child. It isn't mine. What exactly am I missing?

MALACHI

I don't know.

JOSEPH

Then why are you talking?

MALACHI

Because neither do you.

Joseph turns away.

EZRA

He's right.

Joseph turns back, almost offended.

JOSEPH

You're agreeing with him?

EZRA

Don't sound so surprised.

JOSEPH

Ezra.

EZRA

We know Mary is with child. We know what she told you. We know what it looks like.

Beat.

EZRA

We don't know what happened.

JOSEPH

I know enough.

MALACHI

Do you?

Joseph has no patience left for the question.

MARY — FAITH AFTER THE COST

MARY

God was faithful.

ELIZABETH

Yes.

MARY

Then why does obedience feel like everything is falling apart?

ELIZABETH

Because faithful and easy are not the same thing.

Mary looks down.

MARY

I didn't know my yes would cost Joseph.

ELIZABETH

You can't give his answer for him.

MARY

And if he never believes me?

Elizabeth does not promise what she cannot know.

ELIZABETH

Then it will hurt.

Beat.

ELIZABETH

And God will still be faithful.

That is harder to receive than reassurance.

“CHOSEN” REPRISE

A quiet version of Mary's “Chosen” motif begins.

Not a second full song.

Not a power vocal.

The reprise should sound like someone remembering words she once believed more easily.

MARY — MUSICAL TERRITORY

Earlier

I will trust.

Now

I must keep trusting.

Possible lyrical territory

I said yes before I knew

how heavy yes could be.

I saw only the promise—

not what it might ask of me.

Elizabeth may gently join in harmony.

Not preaching.

Supporting.

ELIZABETH — MUSICAL TERRITORY

You don't need the whole road.

You only need the next step.

Mary's motif returns.

MARY

Chosen doesn't mean unafraid...

She almost stops.

Then continues.

It means I trust Him even here.

The reprise resolves quietly.

Mary is not suddenly happy.

She is steadier.

Elizabeth takes her hand.

JOSEPH — ENOUGH

Joseph's side returns fully.

JOSEPH

What exactly am I supposed to pray?

MALACHI

The truth.

JOSEPH

I've been trying to find the truth all night.

MALACHI

No. Your truth.

Joseph looks at him.

MALACHI

Tell God what you know.

Beat.

MALACHI

Then tell Him what you don't.

Joseph looks at all four men.

JOSEPH

Go home.

CALEB

Joseph—

JOSEPH

Please.

Beat.

JOSEPH

I need everyone to stop talking.

They understand.

Levi puts a hand briefly on Joseph's shoulder.

LEVI

We're here tomorrow.

Joseph looks at him. The word lands after everything "tomorrow" has meant.

JOSEPH

I know.

Levi exits.

CALEB

If you need me—

JOSEPH

I know.

Caleb exits.

Ezra notices a tool out of place. Instinctively he puts it where it belongs, then stops himself from trying to fix anything else.

EZRA

For what it's worth...

Joseph waits.

EZRA

I still don't understand it.

JOSEPH

Neither do I.

Ezra exits.

Malachi remains.

JOSEPH

You're still here.

MALACHI

I know.

JOSEPH

Malachi.

MALACHI

Ask Him.

Beat.

MALACHI

That's all.

Malachi exits.

JOSEPH ALONE — THE RHYTHM FAILS

Silence.

Joseph stands in the same workshop that was alive with Brotherhood only hours ago.

He picks up his hammer.

BANG

He waits unconsciously for the answer that used to come from the other men.

Nothing.

BANG. BANG.

Still nothing.

Joseph attempts the familiar sequence.

JOSEPH

Measure.

He measures.

JOSEPH

Mark.

He marks.

He cannot continue.

JOSEPH

Come on.

He resets.

JOSEPH

Measure. Mark...

Nothing.

His hand lowers.

JOSEPH

I can't fix this.

Silence.

For Joseph, that admission is enormous.

JOSEPH'S PRAYER

No polished posture. No sudden eloquence. Joseph sits or leans against the workbench because he is exhausted.

JOSEPH

God...

Long silence.

JOSEPH

I don't know what to ask.

Nothing.

JOSEPH

I know what it looks like.

He hears Malachi in the sentence.

JOSEPH

I thought I knew what happened.

Beat.

JOSEPH

Maybe I don't.

That costs him.

JOSEPH

I know Mary.

Beat.

JOSEPH

I love Mary.

Silence.

JOSEPH

If she's telling the truth...

He cannot finish.

JOSEPH

Please.

Beat.

JOSEPH

Show me what I can't see.

He waits.

The exhaustion of the day finally overtakes him.

THE DREAM

This is the scene's transformational LED moment.

Do not repeat Mary's Gabriel visitation. Joseph's familiar world remains recognizable at first, but it stops obeying the rules he trusts. Sound stretches. Straight workshop lines subtly lose reliable perspective. The unfinished table becomes silhouette. Depth becomes uncertain.

No clouds. No giant wings. No celestial spectacle for its own sake.

An angelic presence is revealed within the altered world.

ANGEL

Joseph.

Joseph stirs within the dream.

ANGEL

Joseph, son of David.

Beat.

ANGEL

Do not be afraid to take Mary as your wife.

Joseph looks toward the presence.

ANGEL

She told you the truth.

That is the blow.

ANGEL

The child she carries comes from God.

Joseph can barely breathe.

JOSEPH

Mary...

ANGEL

She will have a son.

Beat.

ANGEL

You will name him Jesus.

The name is delivered simply. No musical hit. No graphic. No public payoff.

JOSEPH

What am I supposed to do?

Joseph wants the blueprint.

ANGEL

Do not be afraid.

The presence begins to recede.

JOSEPH

Wait.

The dream does not wait.

JOSEPH

What do I—

THE DREAM ENDS

JOSEPH WAKES

Silence.

Joseph wakes sharply.

The ordinary workshop has returned exactly as it was: table, tools, wood, satchel.

He sits for a moment.

Do not rush this. The audience must be allowed to watch the truth reach him and then watch him realize what Mary endured while he did not believe her.

His eyes find the unfinished table.

He touches it.

Earlier, it represented the future Joseph planned. Now it represents something he has been entrusted to serve without controlling.

He notices the satchel Mary made for him. He takes it with him not as a sentimental prop, but because he is going back to her.

Joseph stands.

No speech explaining the dream. No declaration that Mary was telling the truth.

JOSEPH

Mary.

He exits with urgency.

FINAL CROSSCUT

Before the transition completes, Mary and Elizabeth return softly to view.

Mary is sitting with Elizabeth. She does not know what has happened to Joseph.

She does not know he is coming.

The audience does.

For once, the audience is ahead of Mary.

Music begins carrying us toward Scene 8.

END SCENE 7

NOTES

Scene 7 should feel structurally different from anything before it: Mary and Joseph are physically separated, but the audience watches them wrestle with the same crisis at the same time. The source architecture specifically calls for crosscutting their journeys—Mary receiving confirmation from Elizabeth while Joseph receives competing counsel from his friends—before Joseph is finally left alone to pray and receive his dream.

For the naming continuity, I recommend that the angel does tell Joseph, quietly, “You will name him Jesus,” because that belongs to Joseph’s biblical calling. But Joseph will not repeat the name here, and we will not musically spotlight it. Scene 12 remains the major public naming payoff, when Joseph himself answers the shepherds: “Jesus.”

A key thing I would protect in rehearsal is that Elizabeth and Malachi perform parallel functions without sounding alike. Elizabeth helps Mary understand that God’s faithfulness does not guarantee an easy road; Malachi helps Joseph admit that what something looks like and what it is may not be identical. Neither character solves the problem for them. Mary and Joseph still have to make their own choices. That is exactly what the locked architecture calls for.

I also strongly recommend keeping Joseph's prayer “bad” in the best dramatic sense—raw, incomplete, and uncertain. The source specifically warns against suddenly making him eloquent. His breakthrough is simply moving from “I know what happened” to “Maybe I don't.” That humility is what makes the dream feel earned rather than convenient.

And the final symmetry is worth keeping

Scene 3 ends: Mary — “Joseph.”

Scene 7 ends: Joseph — “Mary.”

That makes Scene 8 feel inevitable before either of them has even crossed the stage toward the other.